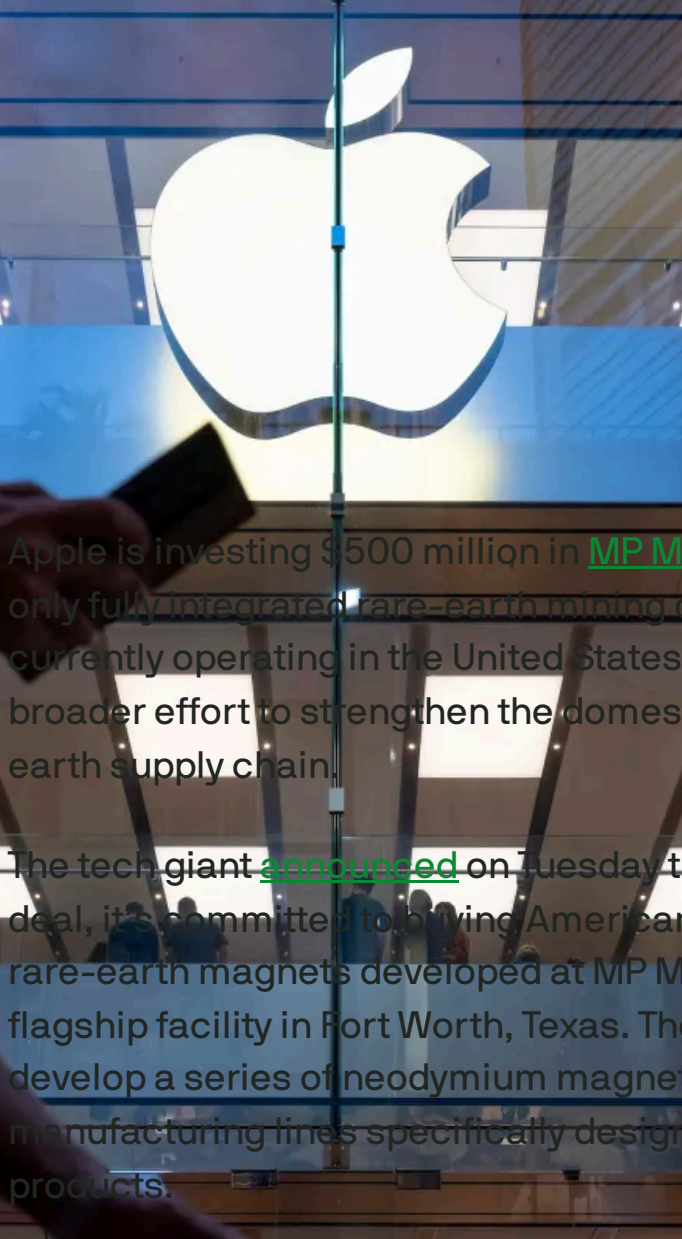


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HARDWARE



Apple commits \$500M to
US-based rare-earth
recycling firm MP
Materials



Aisha Malik — 7:25 AM PDT · July 15, 2025

Apple is investing \$500 million in [MP Materials](#), the only fully integrated rare-earth mining company currently operating in the United States, as part of a broader effort to strengthen the domestic rare-earth supply chain.

The tech giant [announced](#) on Tuesday that with this deal, it's committed to buying American-made rare-earth magnets developed at MP Materials' flagship facility in Fort Worth, Texas. The factory will develop a series of neodymium magnet manufacturing lines specifically designed for Apple products.

IMAGE CREDITS:

Apple says that once the American-made magnets are built, they will be shipped across the country and all over the world to help address increasing global demand for the material.

The two companies will also collaborate to establish a rare-earth recycling line in Mountain Pass, California. The facility will allow MP Materials to process recycled rare-earth feedstock, including materials from used electronics and post-industrial scrap, and reuse it in Apple products.

In addition, the companies will work together to develop novel magnet materials and processing technologies to enhance magnet performance.

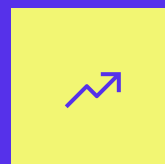
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Apple says the commitment announced on Tuesday is part of its pledge to spend more than \$500 billion in the U.S. over the next four years.

The tech giant first used recycled rare-earth elements in the Taptic Engine of iPhone 11 in 2019. Today, almost all magnets across its devices are made with 100% recycled rare-earth elements.

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Aisha Malik

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Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporte...

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Apple increased the use of recycled materials in



its products to nearly 20% in 2021

Aliya Chaudhry — 7:44 AM PDT · April 19, 2022

Apple has unveiled a series of environmental initiatives, including expanding the use of recycled materials in its products.

In addition to starting to use recycled gold for the first time, Apple has more than doubled the use of recycled tungsten, rare earth elements and cobalt, the company said. In 2021, recycled materials accounted for nearly 20% of the materials in Apple products, which is the highest it has ever been. Last year, 57% of the aluminum in shipped Apple products came from recycled sources, with some products containing 100% recycled material within the enclosure.

IMAGE CREDITS: APPLE

The company aims to end the use of plastics in packaging by 2025. It has reduced the amount of plastics in packaging by 75% since 2015 so that in 2021 the amount of plastics in packaging was down to 4%.

In 2017, the company announced a goal of only using renewable or recyclable materials for its products. Last year, Apple products included 45% recycled rare earth elements and 30% recycled tin. Apple used 100% recycled tin for soldering the main logic board of all new iPhones, iPads, AirPods and Mac products. iPhone batteries also use 13% recycled cobalt. Apple now uses certified recycled

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gold in the iPhone 13 and iPhone 13 Pro for plating the main logic board and the front and rear camera wires.

The benefit of reusing all of this material is that it reduces mining. Apple says that they were able to recover enough gold and copper from one metric ton of iPhone parts as is typically mined from 2,000 metric tons of rock. In addition to reusing materials, Apple delivered 12.2 million refurbished devices last year.

To help with these recycling efforts, Apple is using a crew of robots, including the newly introduced Taz, a machine that uses shredder-like technology to separate magnets from audio modules to recover more rare earth elements. iPhone disassembly robot Daisy, which can disassemble phone batteries and prepare them for resale, is now able to take apart 23 different types of iPhone models. Apple has also offered to license Daisy-related patents to other companies and researchers free of charge.

Apple noted it has another robot, Dave, that disassembles Taptic Engines to help to recover rare earth magnets, tungsten and steel.

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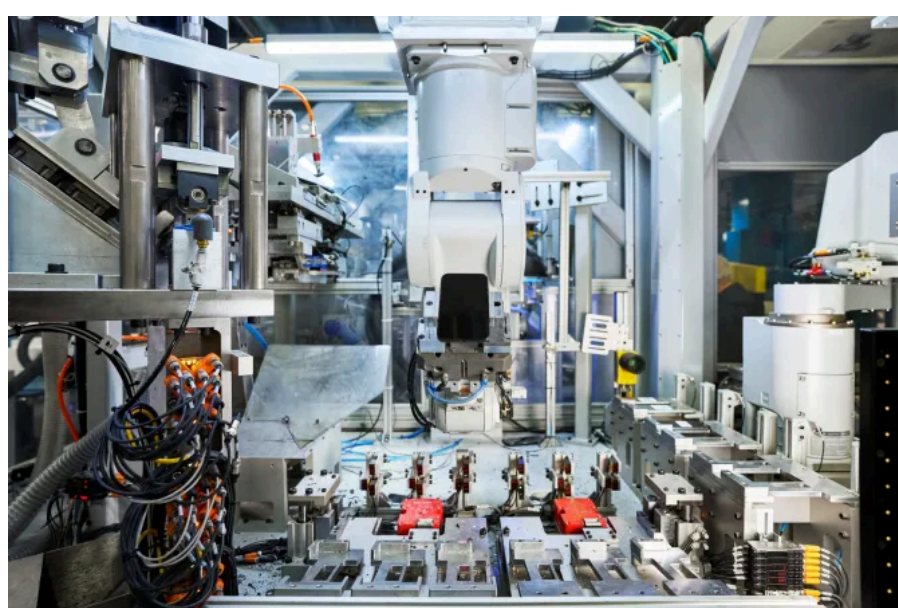


IMAGE CREDITS: APPLE'S DAISY ROBOT

The company also released its [2022 Environmental Progress Report](#), which details its progress toward becoming completely carbon neutral by 2030 and reducing waste. Apple's operations have been carbon neutral since 2020. Since 2018, its offices, stores and data centers have run on 100% renewable energy.

"As people around the world join in celebrating Earth Day, we are making real progress in our work

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maximum donation of \$1 million. This initiative only applies to select countries, including the U.S., U.K. and Canada.

In the U.S. and Canada, users can access guides for nature and green spaces from Lonely Planet, AllTrails and The Nature Conservancy via Apple Maps. Nature-themed cycling, rowing, meditation, yoga and treadmill workouts are now available on Apple Fitness+.

Apple also released a Yosemite National Park episode of its Time to Run programming, as well as an episode of Time to Walk narrated by conservationist Jane Goodall.

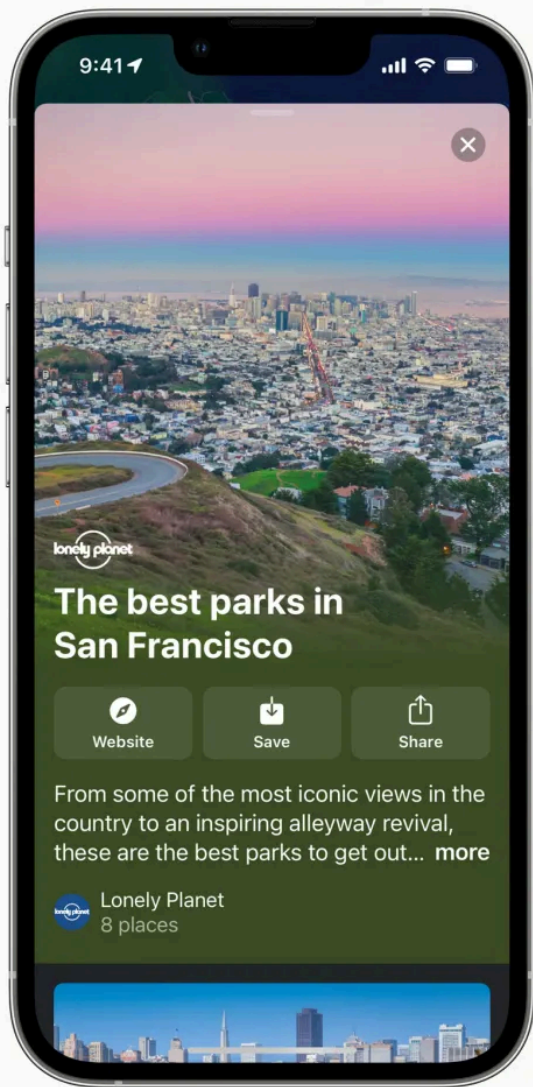
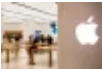


IMAGE CREDITS: APPLE

On April 22, Apple will unveil its augmented reality experience on Snapchat, which allows customers to learn about the environmental efforts involved in the iPhone 13, like the Daisy robot.

Curated collections of environment-related content will be available on Apple News, Apple Podcasts, Apple Books and the Apple TV app. Documentary filmmaker Jennifer Baichwal has curated a selection of films and children's author and visual artist Oliver Jeffers has put together a collection of books.

Apple retail workers at the Grand Central store are trying to unionize



From Activision to Amazon, historic union elections are changing the way that Americans think about work. Now, Apple is the next tech giant to reckon with an employee-driven labor movement. Calling themselves the Fruit Stand Workers United (FSWU), employees at Apple's Grand Central Terminal retail location launched a website designed to educate their fellow workers ... Continue reading

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Apple says its supply chains and products will

be carbon neutral by 2030

Brian Heater — 5:58 AM PDT · July 21, 2020



Apple this morning announced plans to make its entire business carbon neutral within the next 10 years. The news follows the company's push toward a fully carbon neutral corporate structure, adding its manufacturing supply chain and resulting products into the mix.

The roadmap to sustainability as released today is part of the company's annual [Environmental Progress Report](#). Reducing every device it sells to zero climate impact means a couple of things. The primary concern is finding ways to reduce emissions from productions by 75%. The remainder will be focused on efforts to help remove carbon from the atmosphere.

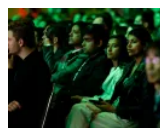
The company has already begun pushing to make a larger percentage of its products from recycled materials, thanks in part to its own in house robots Dave and Daisy (serious *2001* vibes), which recover key rare earth magnets and tungsten, along with some steel recovery. The company also runs its own Material Recovery Lab in Austin, with help from engineers at Carnegie Mellon.

Apple says it's working with more than 70 energy suppliers to go 100% renewable for its production centers, a partnership it believes will reduce

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CLIMATE



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Tim De Chant - Aug 1, 2025

roughly the same amount of carbon emissions annually as three million cars. The company is also working to launch one of the world's biggest solar arrays in Europe. As far as the remaining 25% of carbon reduction, there are a number of initiatives outlined in the report, including efforts to restore forests in Africa and South America.

There are also plans to launch an "Impact Accelerator," aimed at investing in minority-owned businesses launched as part of the company's Racial Equity and Justice Initiative. As for how that relates to the topic of sustainability, VP Lisa Jackson says in a press release, "Systemic racism and climate change are not separate issues, and they will not abide separate solutions. We have a generational opportunity to help build a greener and more just economy, one where we develop whole new industries in the pursuit of giving the next generation a planet worth calling home."

Apple has generally [received high marks](#) from Greenpeace in recent years for its aggressive efforts to limit the impact of its massive global operations.

Topics: [Apple](#) [carbon neutral](#) [Climate](#) [Greenpeace](#)

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Brian Heater was the Hardware Editor at TechCrunch until early 2025. He has worked for a number of leading tech...

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